

		Category 3 - ₹70,000 and above				Misc.
Lenovo	Acer	Fujitsu	Dell	Samsung	Asus	
IdeaPad U410 (59-342-788)	Aspire S3-391	Lifebook U772 Red	XPS 14	Series 9 (NP-900X3C)	S56CA	
63,990	66,949	75,900	85,990	1,02,990	To be launched	
60,000	69,000	75,900	85,990	1,02,990	To be launched	
17.70	14.68	18.05	21.85	23.68	19.09	
17.78	13.41	15.56	17.11	15.53	18.52	
20.76	18.96	19.80	23.76	24.60	20.52	
56.24	47.05	53.41	62.73	63.82	58.13	
Intel Core i7 - 3517U	Intel Core i7 - 3517U	Intel Core i5 - 3427U	Intel Core i5 - 3317U	Intel Core i7 - 3517U	Intel Core i7 - 3517U	
2	2	2	2	2	2	
1900	1900	1800	1700	1900	1900	
4	4	4	4	4	4	
Nvidia GeForce GT610M / Intel HD4000	Intel HD 4000	Intel HD 4000	Nvidia GeForce GT 630M / Intel HD 4000	Intel HD 4000	Nvidia GeForce GT635M / Intel HD 4000	
1 GB	0	0	1 GB	0	2 GB	
HDD	HDD	SSD	HDD	SSD	HDD	
500	500	128	500	256	500	
24	24	0	32	0	24	
14	13.3	14	14	13.3	15.6	
1366 x 768	1366 x 768	1366 x 768	1600 x 900	1600 x 900	1366 x 768	
4	2	3	2	2	3	
2	2	2	2	1	2	
Y / Y / Y	Y / Y / Y	N / Y / Y	Y / Y / Y	Optional / Y / Y	Y / Y / Y	
N	N	N	N	N	Y	
1.7	1.35	1.4	2.1	1.16	2.3	
193	153	158	210	246	221	
17	15	14	13	16	17	
10	5	8	7	6	10	
11	9	11	10	10	10	
2.79	2.79	2.6	2.38	2.8	2.79	
16.05	12.56	12.9	30.26	16.39	25.23	
656	0	0	1141	0	1083	
2037	2383	4221	3159	4647	2176	
13600	3314	42453	16927	41503	3851	

neck with the AMD Radeon HD7670M (2GB) of the Envy 4. Its battery lasted 210 minutes, expect it to last even longer in real-world usage. Do remember that the XPS 14 range starts at around ₹79,000, for the version with no dedicated GPU. As far as the Samsung Series 9 goes, it does look really admirable. Stop admiring the gorgeous looks for a second, switch it on and the goodness continues. Its PC Mark 07 scores are the highest across board, and its tested battery life of 246 minutes

is also the highest among this bunch of ultrabooks. The 256GB SSD on the Series 9 is extremely fast, and is pipped only just by the 128GB SSD on the Fujitsu Lifebook. That really helps with the system performance. The display has a resolution of 1600 x 900 pixels, but unlike the Dell XPS 14, this one is not reflective. The cherry on the cake is the brightness level, which is consistently higher than the XPS 14's display at similar brightness settings. The only thing missing from this

package is a dedicated graphics chip, and that would probably round off an unbeatable package.

THE WINNERS

Best Performer:

Samsung Series 9

Among all ultrabooks, the Samsung Series 9 has the best performance, the maximum battery life and very good, rugged build quality. Of course, all that comes at a price, but even though this ultrabook is mighty expensive, this is the one to buy if you

are searching for the best performing ultrabook in the market.

Best Buy (Category 1 - ₹40,000 to ₹54,999)

Dell Inspiron 14z: This is the most in-expensive ultrabook in this test, and the stable performance and good build quality sweetens the deal even more at this price. Perfect machine to introduce you to the world of ultrabooks.

Best Buy (Category 2 - ₹55,000 to ₹69,999)

HP Envy 4: The performance of the Envy 4 is so good that it is actually in a solid second place overall in terms of performance. It's priced attractively as well, compared to the Samsung Series 9. Brilliantly built as well, feeling more expensive than it actually is. Recommended for anyone who wants a very powerful ultrabook under ₹60,000.

Best Value (Category 3 - ₹70,000 and above)

Dell XPS 14: The XPS 14 really made the ultrabook fashionable, with the use of exotic materials that add to the solidity and the premium feel of the package. Performance is excellent, but more than that, it is equally capable as a road-warrior and as a light entertainment/gaming laptop for home.

Editor's Pick

Samsung Series 5: This is a very capable alternative to the HP Envy 4. Out of the box, you get 6GB of RAM (as against the popular 4GB trend), a 1TB hard drive (as against the popular 500GB trend) and an optical drive. Build quality isn't as great as the HP Envy 4's or even the Lenovo IdeaPad U410's, but performance more than makes up for it. In terms of its configuration, it offers a unique mix not found in any other ultrabook out there.